

ACT I

THE IDEA

*You can draw
amazing things
on paper...*

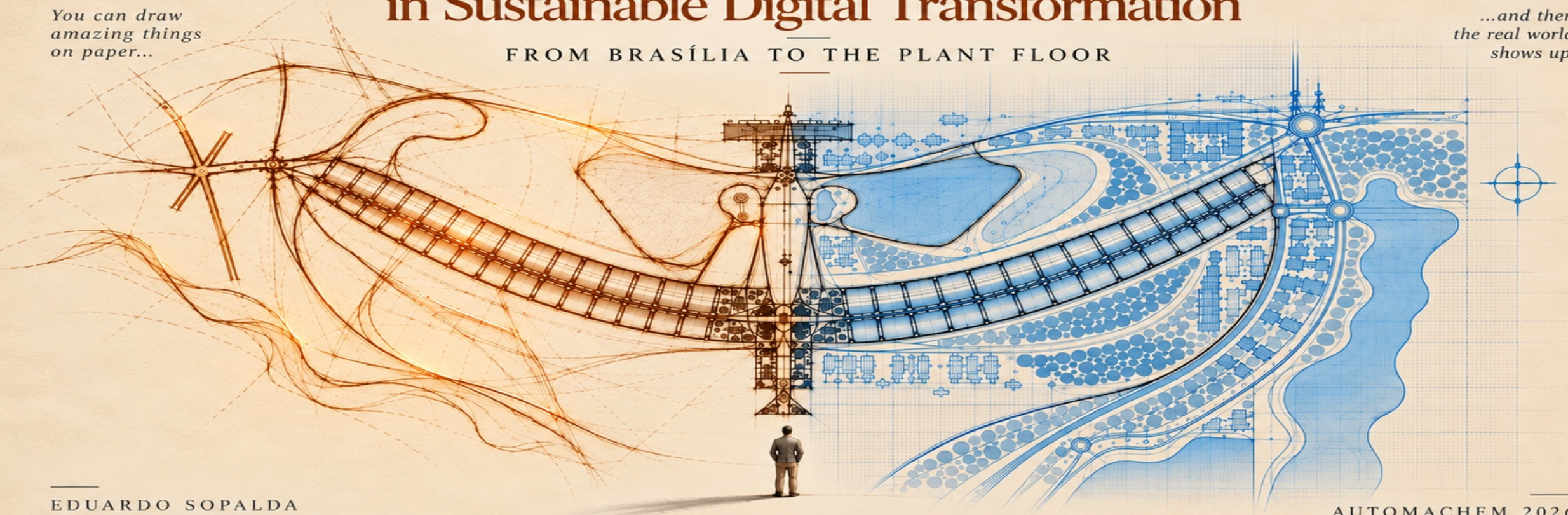
People, Data and AI in Sustainable Digital Transformation

FROM BRASÍLIA TO THE PLANT FLOOR

ACT II

REALITY

*...and then
the real world
shows up.*



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D&T - Global Data Governance Lead

dsm-firmenich ●●●

PEOPLE | PLANET | PROGRESS

WE BRING PROGRESS TO LIFE

AUTOMACHEM 2026

BERLIN · 26 OCTOBER 2026

OPENING PANEL

AUTOMA CHEM 2026 / PRESENTATION SYSTEM

VISUAL IDENTITY & ART DIRECTION

BRAND BIBLE · PEOPLE, DATA AND AI IN SUSTAINABLE DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION

2026

01 / NORTH STAR

A presentation designed as an architectural system.

The deck should feel closer to a premium architecture / design publication than to a conventional corporate technology deck. Its visual language is deliberately restrained, editorial and materially grounded.

The central duality

- IDEA — warm, human, authored, imperfect, copper, expressive.
- REALITY — cool, technical, structured, distributed, blueprint blue.
- BRIDGE — neutral space where governance, data, definitions and people connect the two.

The visual system should
make the argument
before the audience
has consciously
analysed it.

No generic AI imagery. No neon. No glassmorphism. No decorative novelty without narrative purpose.

02 / VISUAL PSYCHOLOGY

Design what the audience should perceive next.

The system combines visual hierarchy, Gestalt grouping, cognitive-load discipline, colour salience, spatial rhythm and temporal continuity. These principles are not decoration; they are the perceptual architecture of the deck.

ATTENTION

One dominant focal point. Scale is the first hierarchy mechanism; colour is secondary.

GROUPING

Proximity, similarity, continuity, figure–ground and connectedness make relationships legible.

COHERENCE

Remove irrelevant detail. Keep labels spatially and temporally close to what they explain.

Research basis: visual selective attention; Gestalt principles; Mayer's multimedia learning principles including coherence, signaling, spatial contiguity and temporal contiguity.

RHYTHM

Alternate dense technical fields with quiet typographic space. Empty space is a boundary.

The rule: remove competition, not character.

03 / COLOUR ARCHITECTURE

The palette is a grammar, not a collection of swatches.

PAPER

canvas
#F3DDC0

PAPER LIGHT

quiet field
#F1E4D1

BURNED COPPER

idea / emphasis
#762F0B

COPPER LIGHT

glow / secondary
#D89C67

BLUEPRINT

technical drawing
#5F92B8

BLUE PALE

secondary system
#8DB5D2

INK

typography / anchor
#0F0F11

TECH GREY

secondary structure
#48565F

BLUE TEXT

candidate accessible text blue
#365F7C

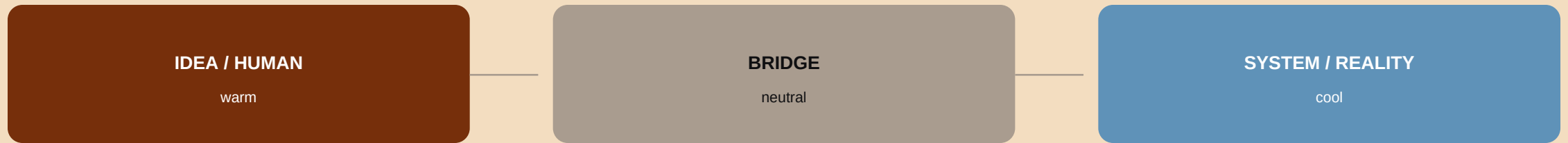
SEMANTIC RULE

Parchment = environment. Copper = authored idea. Blue = system and evidence. Black = hierarchy. Pale tones = support.

04 / COLOUR + COGNITION

Warm / cool opposition becomes narrative grammar.

A 2025 systematic review of 132 peer-reviewed articles covering 42,266 participants in 64 countries found systematic colour–emotion associations, but also many-to-many relationships strongly influenced by hue, lightness, saturation and context. Associations are not universal causal effects.



IMPORTANT

Do not use colour as a simplistic emotional code. Meaning emerges from repeated semantic use, spatial context, contrast and interaction with typography.

Colour should be remembered as meaning, not as decoration.

05 / CONTRAST + LEGIBILITY

INK / PAPER	14.51:1	Body and titles
COPPER / PAPER	7.29:1	Emphasis
BLUEPRINT / PAPER	2.53:1	Graphics; not small text
COPPER LIGHT / PAPER	1.79:1	Glow only; not text
BLUE TEXT / PAPER	5.16:1	Candidate technical text

WCAG 2.2 reference: 4.5:1 minimum for normal text and 3:1 for large text. These are useful production checks for presentation work, especially when texture or imagery sits behind text.

06 / TYPOGRAPHY

Two voices. One system.

Public dsm-firmenich design documentation identifies DM Sans as the primary typeface and Lora as its serif companion, with an 8px baseline-grid logic and defined Display / Headline / Title / Body / Label / Link / Footnote roles. This makes DM Sans + Lora the corporate-safe reference system. It does not prove that Lora is the exact display face in the supplied artwork.

THE SYSTEM LOOKS PERFECT FROM ABOVE.

DATA / PROCESS / PEOPLE / GOVERNANCE

SERIF = narrative voice SANS = system voice

The serif shown here is a neutral editorial specimen only; final specimen testing should use the actual font files.

PROVISIONAL TYPE SCALE

Display / cover	64–78 px / 48–59 pt	serif
Subhead	30–42 px / 23–32 pt	serif or sans
Section label	13–16 px / 10–12 pt	sans
Body	19–24 px / 14–18 pt	sans
Caption	12–15 px / 9–11 pt	sans
Pull quote	22–30 px / 17–23 pt	serif italic

07 / FONT SELECTION — DECISION FRAME

Do not lock the display face until the exact title is tested in the real composition. The decision should be made against cognitive and editorial posture, not personal preference alone.

LORA	literary / human / accessible	Corporate-safe reference	Potentially too polite
BODONI / DIDOT	high-contrast / architectural / editorial	Strong authority	Can become fashion-editorial
CORMORANT	intellectual / expressive	Distinctive	Can become romantic
CANELA-STYLE	contemporary editorial / luxury	Very distinctive	Licensing / approval
DM SERIF-LIKE	modern editorial	Controlled transition	Less architectural
OTHER APPROVED SERIF	depends on specimen	Potential best fit	Must test

Decision test

Authority / Humanity / Architectural character / Auditorium readability / Compatibility with DM Sans

08 / GRID + COMPOSITION

12 COLUMNS

The deck uses a 16:9 canvas and a 12-column editorial grid. The grid should be visible through alignment, not through visible grid lines.

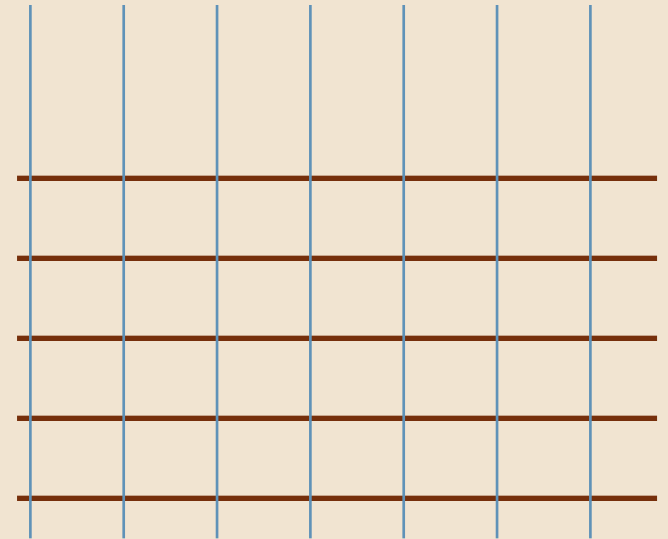
~5% outer margin / ~24 px gutters / 8 px baseline rhythm

Hierarchy: 1) hero statement 2) primary visual 3) secondary annotation 4) metadata 5) brand.

09 / IMAGE + MATERIAL LANGUAGE

- Architectural drawing language: plan, section, contour, line, annotation, measured relationships.
- Paper should feel matte and physical, with subtle grain rather than synthetic texture.
- Copper linework retains slight human imperfection; technical blue remains precise.
- Photography, when used, should feel documentary/editorial rather than glossy stock.
- Diagrams privilege relationships and spatial logic over generic icons.
- Avoid rounded-card UI, dashboard aesthetics, glassmorphism, heavy shadows and generic AI imagery.

material > decoration



10 / MOTION LANGUAGE

The drawing moves. The composition does not.

- Locked camera. No zoom, pan, tilt, rotation, reframing or parallax.
- Typography and logos remain static.
- The human figure remains completely static.
- Only existing linework is revealed, recoloured or subtly illuminated.
- Copper sketch reveals first; blueprint reality follows.
- Transition is quiet: technical reality feels as if it was always underneath.
- Glow is thin, soft, local warmth — never neon, bloom, rays or particles.
- Final 4–5 second static hold.

CORE MOTION STATEMENT

The audience should understand the problem, not admire the animation.

11 / SLIDE ARCHETYPES

THE STATEMENT

One sentence + one visual field

Serif headline / minimal support

THE DRAWING

Large diagram + small annotation

Let linework carry the story

THE CONTRAST

Two visual systems side by side

Warm/cool or human/system

THE EVIDENCE

One number + context

No dashboard wall

THE BRIDGE

Conceptual statement + system detail

Copper + blue coexist

THE QUESTION

Large question + quiet field

Maximum whitespace

```
--paper: #F3DDC0;
--paper-light: #F1E4D1;
--ink: #0F0F11;
--copper: #762F0B;
--copper-light: #D89C67;
--blueprint: #5F92B8;
--blueprint-pale: #8DB5D2;
--blueprint-text: #365F7C;
--technical-grey: #48565F;

--color-canvas: var(--paper);
--color-text: var(--ink);
--color-idea: var(--copper);
--color-system: var(--blueprint);
--color-system-text: var(--blueprint-text);
--color-highlight: var(--copper-light);
```

PRODUCTION RULES

- Max two type families across the deck.
- Serif is voice; sans is infrastructure.
- Never introduce a new accent colour without semantic justification.
- Do not use blue as small body text unless the darker text-blue token is used.
- Use 8px spacing rhythm where practical.
- Use whitespace before adding another graphic.
- Do not change the meaning of a colour from slide to slide.

13 / BRAND GOVERNANCE + SOURCES

This document distinguishes presentation art direction from official corporate identity. Public dsm-firmenich design documentation supports DM Sans + Lora and an 8px baseline-grid approach. The authenticated Brand Center remains authoritative for exact corporate colours, logo specifications, clear-space rules, templates and approved assets.

RESEARCH BASIS

dsm-firmenich Supernova — Typography

DM Sans primary; Lora companion; type roles and 8px baseline-grid logic.

<https://dsm-firmenich.supernova-docs.io/latest/styles/styles/typography/overview-ZpjnctIW>

Hosseini & Ghabanchi, Journal of Neurolinguistics (2022)

20 young adults in Iran; colour, EEG, emotion and vocabulary retention. Useful but limited evidence; not a universal memory claim.

<https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S0911604422000276>

Jonauskaite et al., Psychological Science (2025)

Systematic review of 132 articles, 42,266 participants, 64 countries; colour–emotion associations and the role of lightness, saturation and hue.

<https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12325498/>

W3C WCAG 2.2

4.5:1 normal text; 3:1 large text; useful production reference for legibility.

<https://www.w3.org/TR/wcag/>

AUTOMA CHEM 2026

Berlin; chemical automation and digitalisation congress; audience context supports the technical/editorial positioning.

<https://automachem.com/>

14 / THE ART-DIRECTOR RULE

What should the audience
notice, understand
or feel next?

Every decision in the deck — colour, type, image, line, spacing, transition, animation — must answer that question.

If it has no job,
remove it.

The goal is not to make the presentation look designed. The goal is to make the audience experience a designed argument.